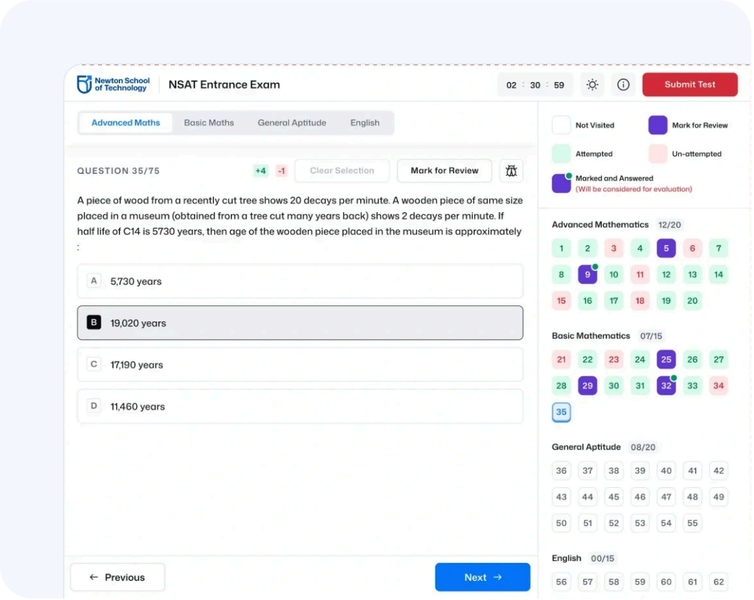


Growth season 2025–26
Newton School of Technology

Product design, growth systems, and the first high-stakes product experience.

Gaurav Kumar
Senior Product Designer

season-banner

A wide filler: campus, students, an event from the season

4/1

The season was a system, not a campaign.

Discovery · Acquisition products · Signup · Application · Payment · Exam

Act I Building the growth system

Act II The exam experience

01 05 09 13 17 21

A high-intent journey, with many handoffs.



Discovery → signup → application form → NSAT payment → exam

campus-delhi
Delhi campus photo
4/3
Delhi

campus-pune
Pune campus photo
4/3
Pune

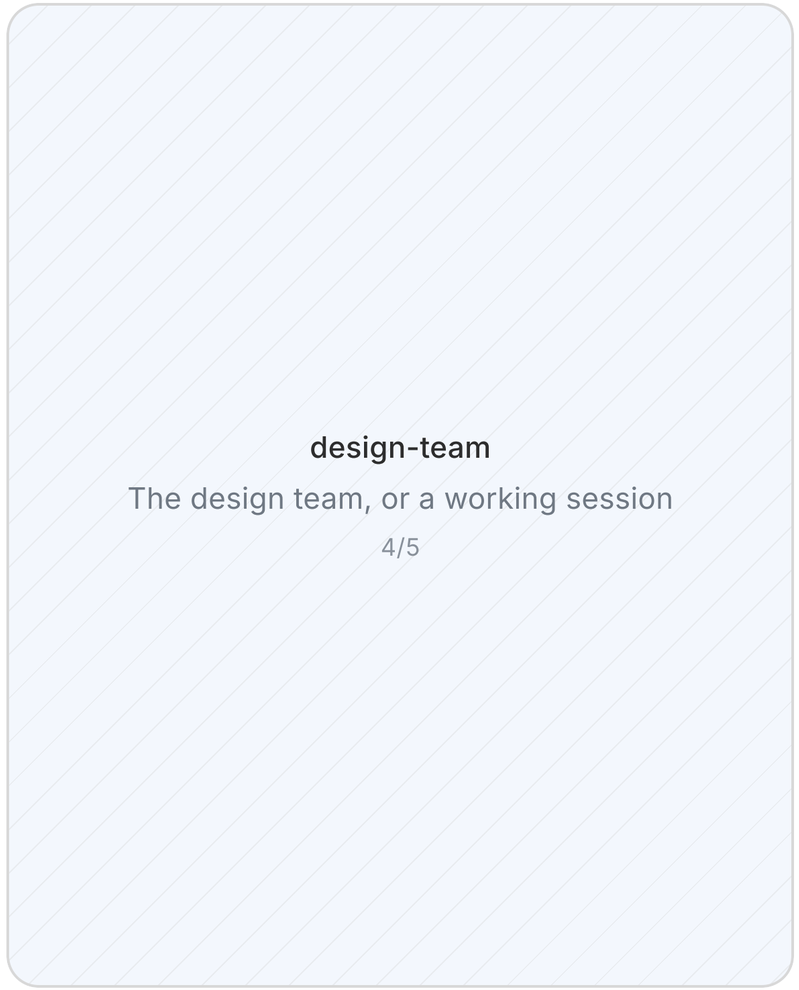
campus-bengaluru
Bengaluru campus photo
4/3
Bengaluru

campus-hyderabad
Hyderabad campus photo
4/3
Hyderabad

Five verticals.
One design function.

There was no design team when I joined. I built and led one.

Working with product, engineering, marketing, content and academics.



design-team

The design team, or a working session

4/5

First, one recognisable brand. September 2025.

Newton School of Technology

brand-guidelines
A page from the brand guidelines
3/4
Guidelines

brand-campus
A campus poster or banner
3/4
Campus

brand-social
A social or ad creative
3/4
Social

brand-portal
The central brand portal
3/4
Brand portal

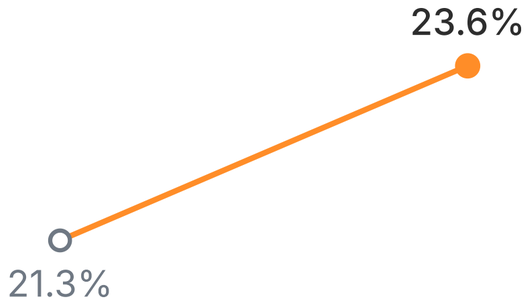
Logos, colours, type, photography and product screenshots, from one portal.

18 pages in 21 days. Signups went up.

website-home

The redesigned homepage, desktop

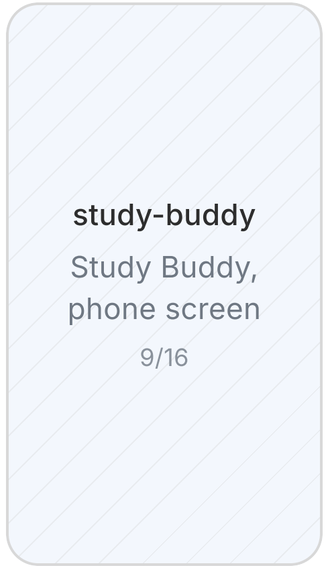
16/10



+2.3 pp

signup conversion, at 98% confidence

Products that created demand before anyone applied.



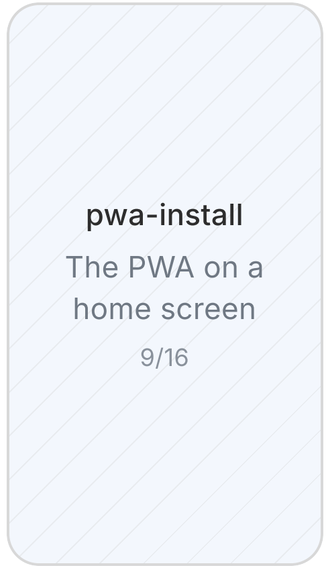
Study Buddy

110,589 users · 14.4% went on to pay for NSAT



Head Start

Free coding courses: Python, C++, fundamentals



The PWA

Students who installed it paid 23% more often. Observed, not causal.

The season at a glance.

909,850 unique top-of-funnel acquisitions

15,930 unique payers, about 1.75% of the line above, drawn to scale

20,152 payments

includes retries, so these are payments, not people

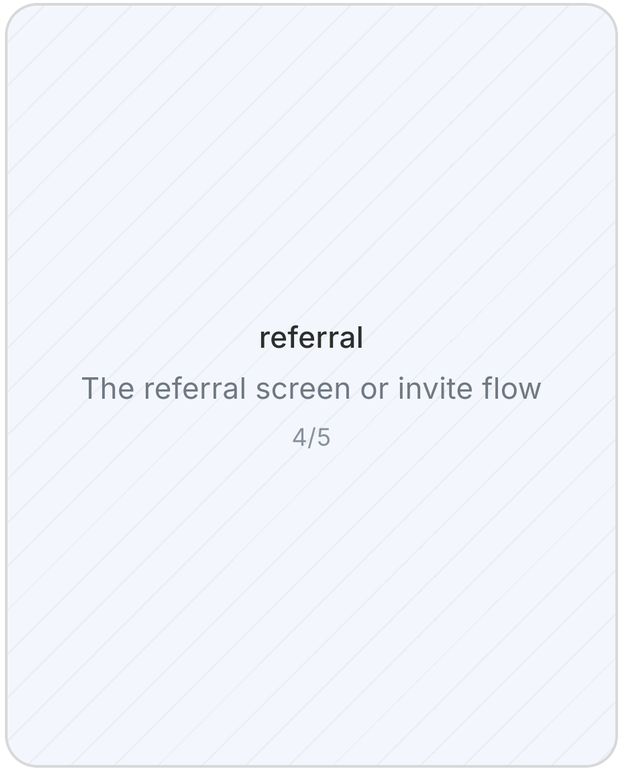
Referral brought the highest intent.

3,468
came through referral

1,274
paid

36.7%
referral → paid

Referral conversion improved 21% year over year.



Small changes, deeper in the funnel.

notification-centre
The notification centre
16/9

Notification centre

Students who saw it converted 30% higher. Observed, not causal.

application-page
The application page
16/9

Application page · 47.7% apply → paid

33,424 unique visitors → 15,930 unique payers

team-working

Cross-functional team, a review or launch moment

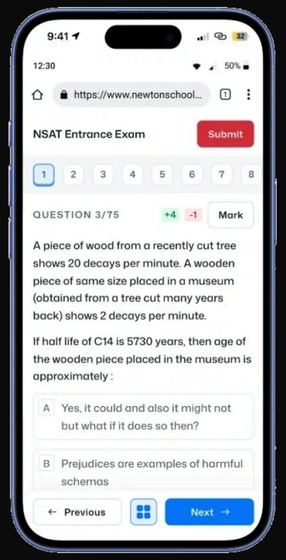
4/5

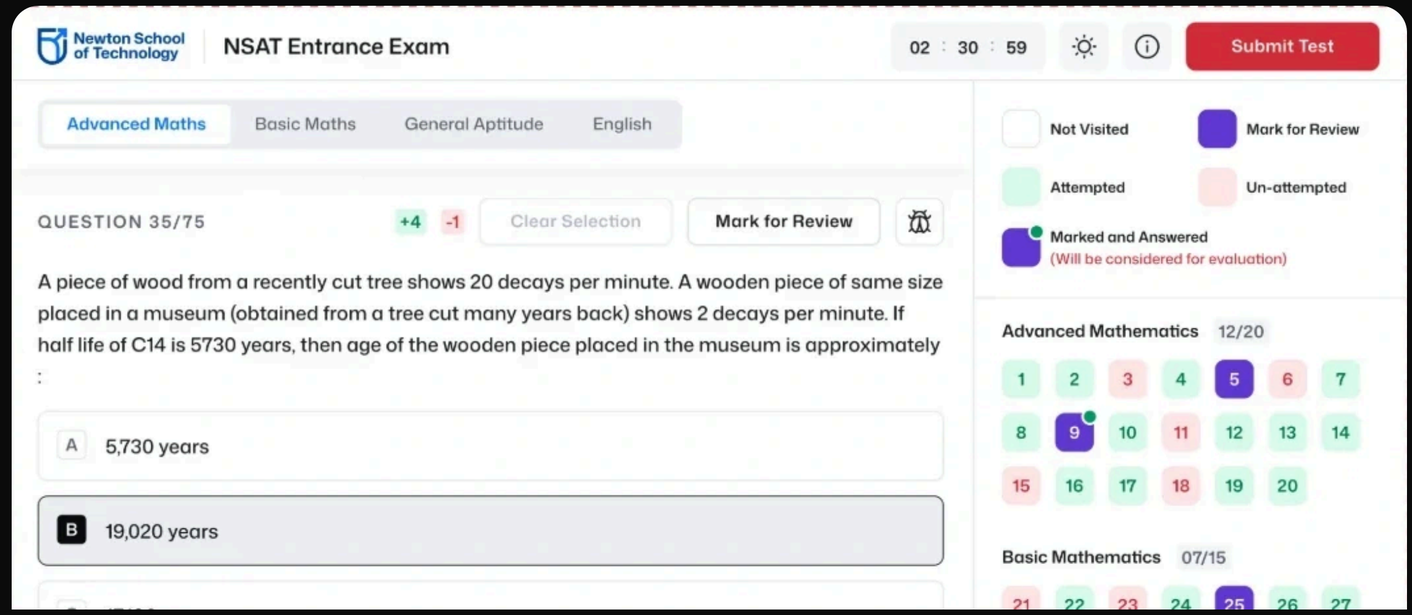
The work only moved when the system moved.

Design •	me
Product	product lead
Engineering	senior developer + 8 engineers
Marketing	~6 marketers
Content	content writers
Academic	academic and teaching teams

The first long product experience was the exam.

Redesigning the NSAT / NSET exam interface.



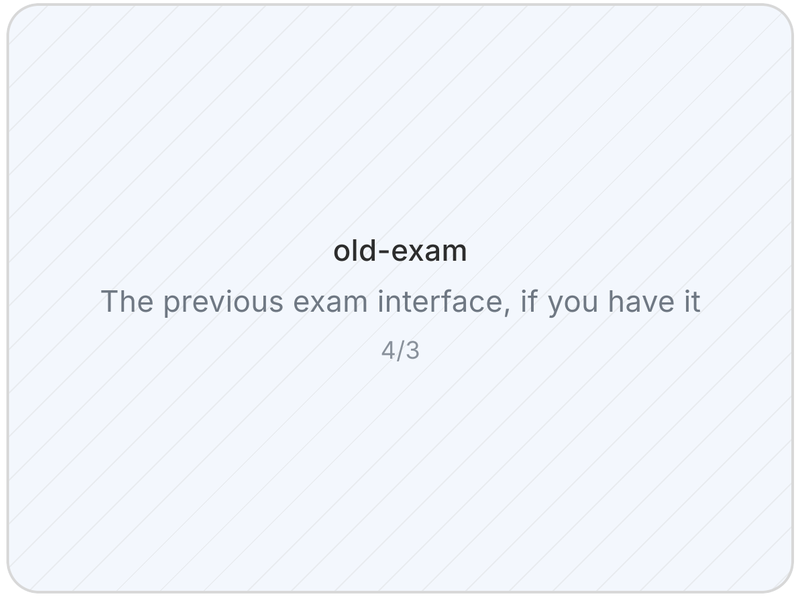


Students were learning the interface before taking the exam.

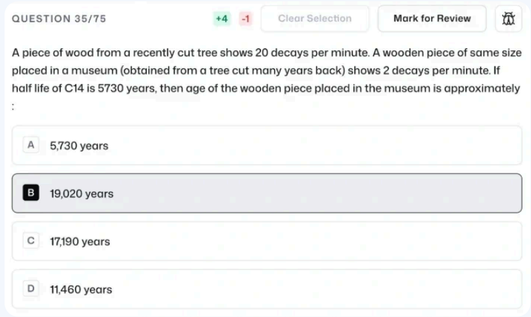
5–6 min

to understand how it worked, as reported

It lacked cohesion, and moving between sections meant going back and forth.

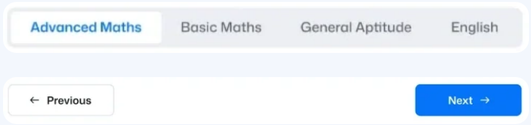


Design for confidence under pressure.



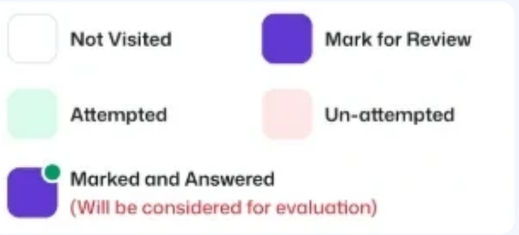
Reduce cognitive load

One question at a time, the chosen answer filled solid.



Predictable navigation

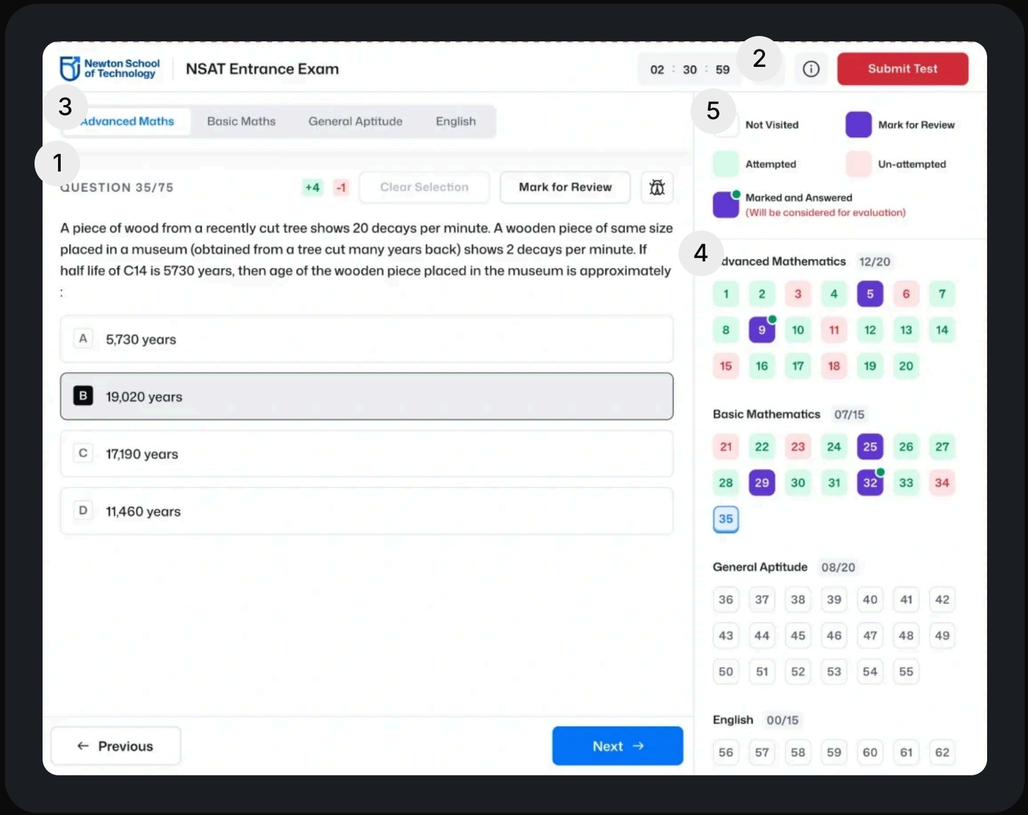
Sections as tabs. Previous and Next never move.



Clear progress and states

Every state has its own colour, with a legend on screen.

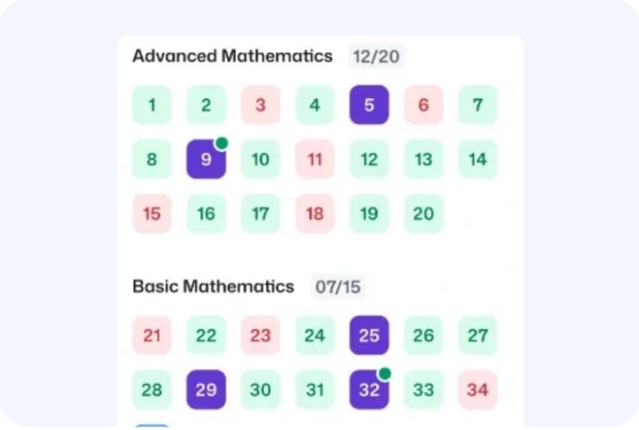
One exam canvas. Less friction.



1. Full-width question
2. Light / dark toggle
3. Section tabs
4. Question navigation, collapsible
5. Question and review states

dark mode was there to ease glare on a long exam

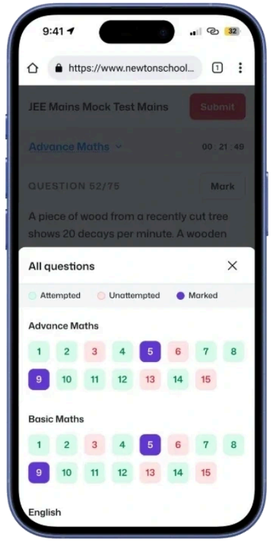
Move through the exam without losing your place.



Every question by section, with a count for each.



“Marked and answered” still counts. One less worry.



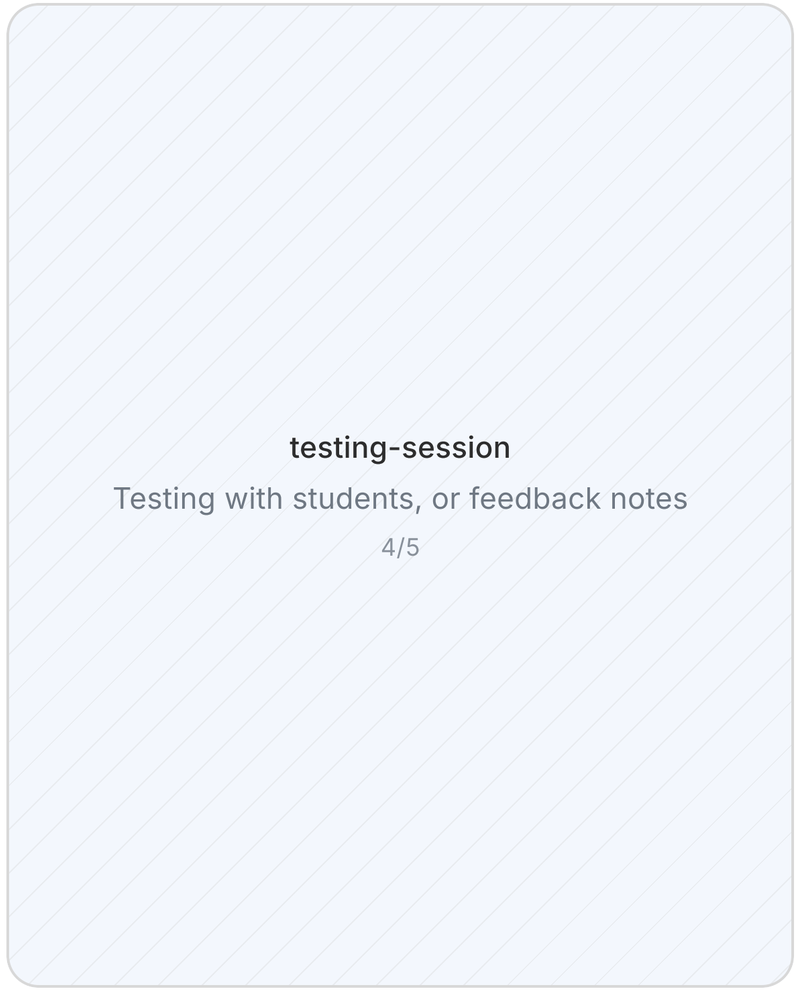
On mobile, the same overview as a sheet.

It had to fit the system underneath.

Backend and storage integration set the limits.

Constraints → Exploration → Student feedback → Iteration → Launch

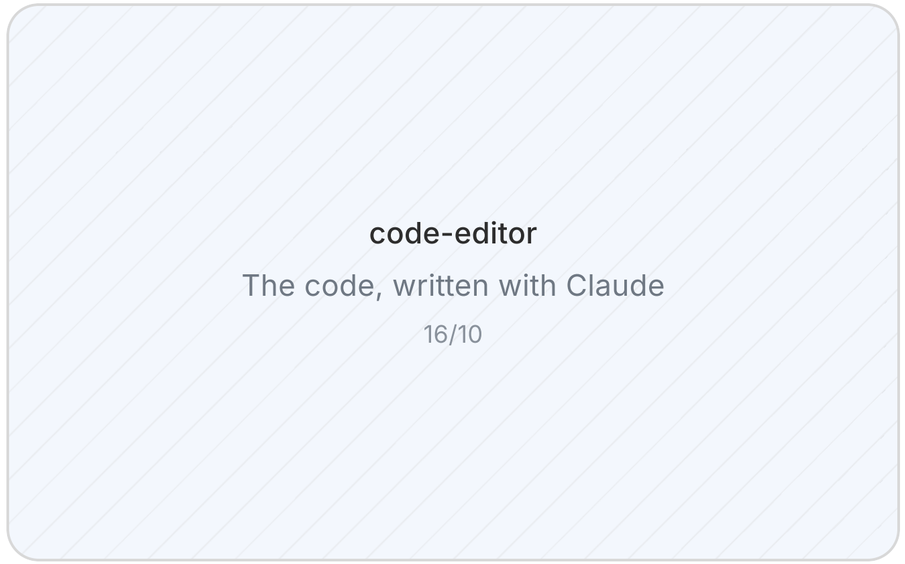
Internal testing, online students contacted for feedback, and new patterns tried with a small group first.



Designed, then built in the real codebase.



Product thinking and design: me



~80% of the code, written by me with Claude · ~2–3 hours of developer integration

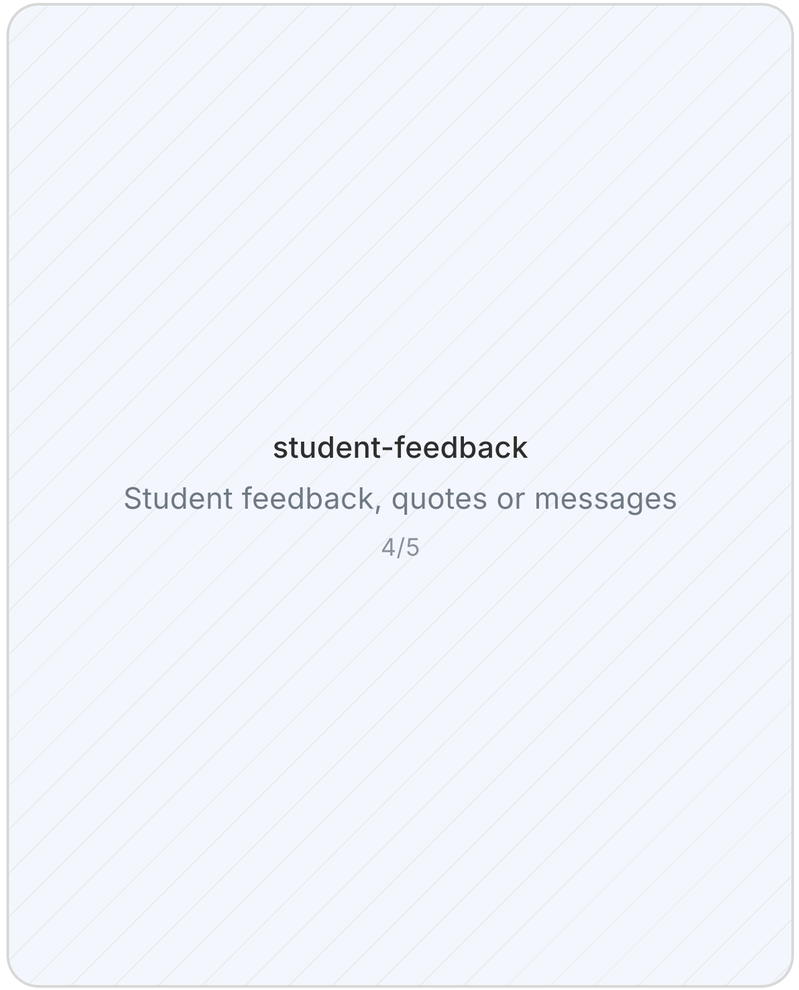
my own numbers. A developer took it to production.

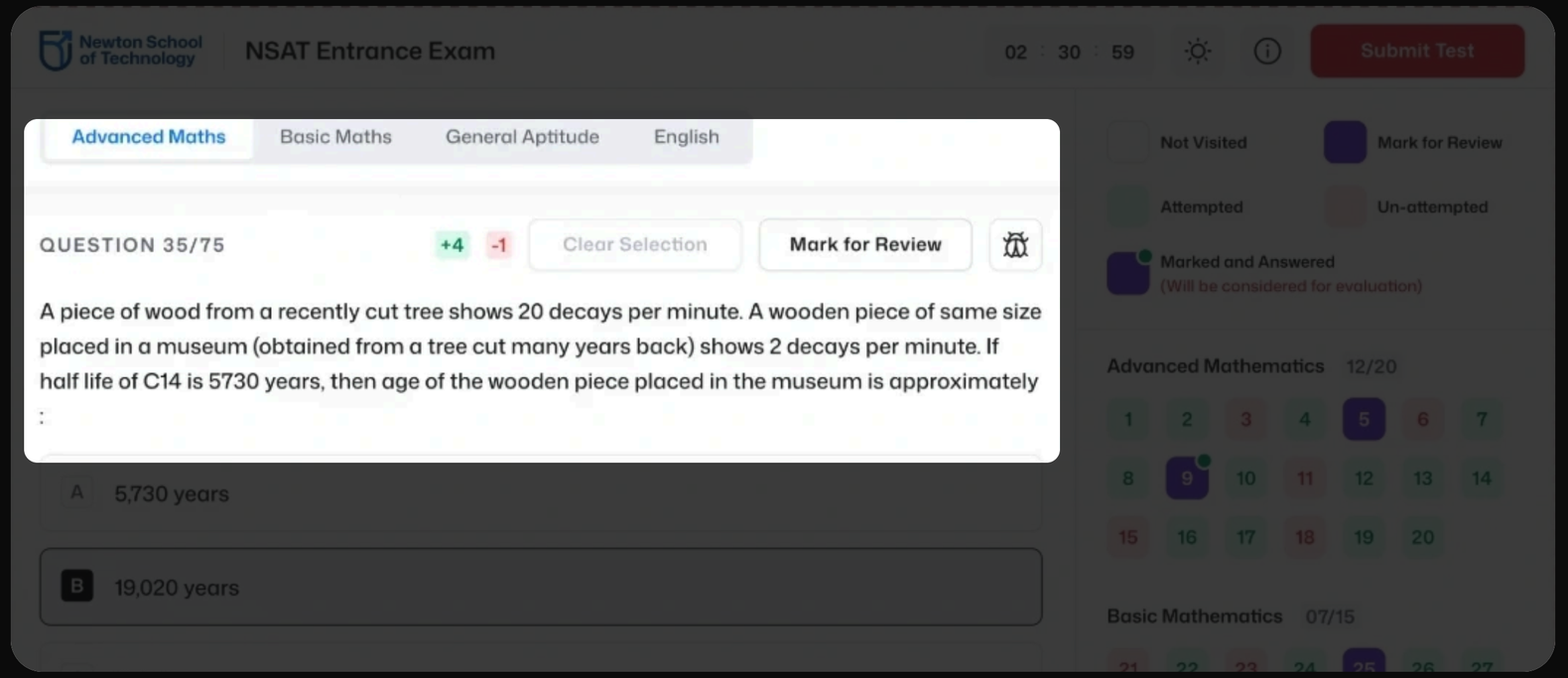
A clearer interface. A better exam.

3.7 → 4.2

1 2 3 4 5

Reported satisfaction, out of 5. Sample and method still to verify.





The interface should disappear. The exam should remain.

Design creates leverage when it works as a system.

moment-1

A filler photo from the season

4/3

Consistency across touchpoints

moment-2

A filler photo from the season

4/3

The whole journey, not one screen

moment-3

A filler photo from the season

4/3

Care where the stakes are high

Start with the business. Stay with the user. Ship it.

01 Understand the business goal

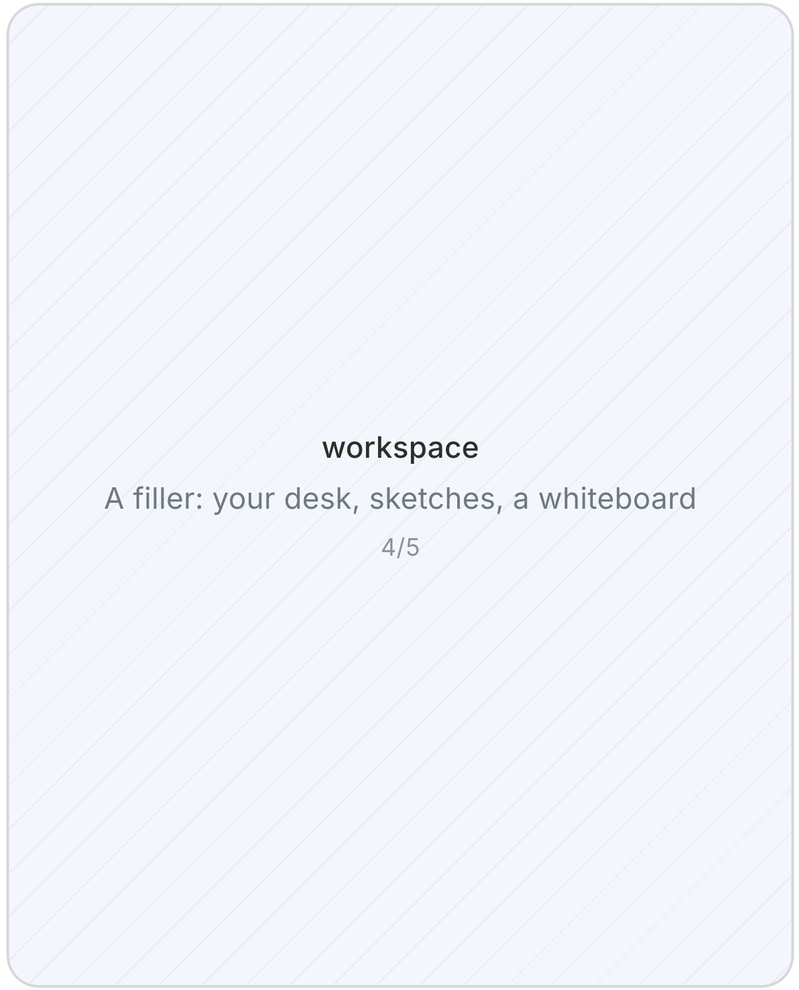
02 Find the user problem

03 Define the critical journey

04 Design and validate

05 Ship with engineering

06 Measure, and start again



The next iteration starts with better evidence.

proposed, not done yet

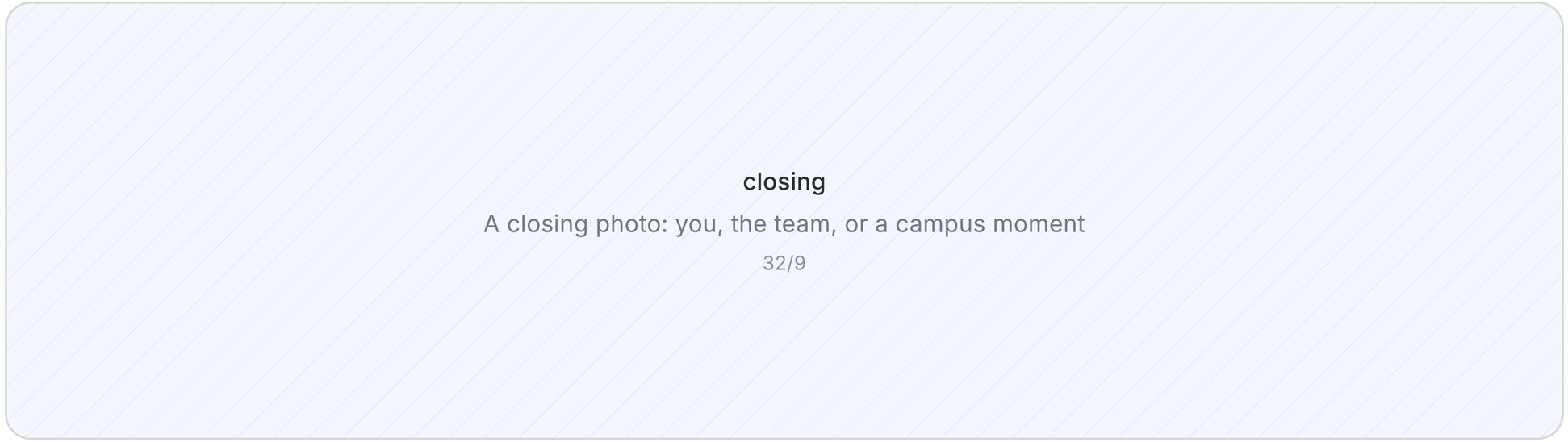
01 Validate the satisfaction baseline and method

02 Measure task completion and navigation friction

03 Check performance across devices

04 Keep testing navigation and section switching

05 Tie interface changes to confidence and completion



Build experiences that move the business forward.

Thank you.